



MONDAY

**JESUS WELCOMES
CHILDREN AND ADULTS**

**MEMORY
VERSE**

Jesus said, “Let the little children come to Me, and do not forbid them; for of such is the kingdom of heaven.” *Matthew 19:14 NKJV*

INTRODUCTION RESPECTING ALL AGES

In Jesus' time the elderly were often treated with respect, and children were often pushed aside, or considered unimportant. Jesus knew that children are very important because the way that we treat them when they are young will shape how they will treat others when they grow up. When older people treat children with love and respect, they will also learn to see God as loving and respectful.

Jesus cared for young and old alike. But when

one group of people was being ignored or hurt, then Jesus focused on showing them special care and attention, to teach His disciples, and us, how to become more like Him.

Jesus blessed children, healed them, and enjoyed their lively worship. He let a young boy help him feed 5000 people. He raised a widow's son and Jairus's daughter from the dead.

When we treat people of all ages with the same love, compassion, and respect, then we are treating people of diverse ages as Jesus treated them.

Jesus focused on showing them special care and attention.

JESUS WELCOMES MOTHERS AND CHILDREN

Read together
the story of
Jesus and the
children:
Matthew 19

“Jesus is here!” The news ripples through the town with joyful excitement. Mothers pick up their children and sing on their way to the marketplace. Sarah gathers a handful of wildflowers and David grabs a pomegranate from the table.

As they turn a corner, they see Jesus resting under a tree. Sarah runs towards Him, then suddenly she stops. Men with cross faces are standing in her way. “No. You can’t see Jesus. He’s tired and hungry. Run-away little girl!” Sarah starts to cry. When the mothers and children see the grumpy disciples their singing stops and their smiles fade.

When Jesus sees their sad faces, He is sad too. He looks at His disciples and sighs. It was only a few days ago that He took a child in His arms and taught them that children have a special place in God’s kingdom. And here they are, chasing them all away...

Jesus calls out: “Hey! Please don’t turn the children away! They are so precious that their angels always see the face of My loving Father in heaven. Welcome them! Let them come to Me and see My loving face too!”

Jesus holds out His arms and smiles His biggest smile! “Come here children! There’s room for everyone!” They laugh as they run towards Jesus. He picks up the smallest one, to keep her safe from the crush. She limps. He gently touches her ankle. It will be better now. She smiles and hugs Him, burying her little face in His beard.

He tells them about a shepherd who loves his sheep and knows each one by name.

He is a brave and loving shepherd who will even go into the wild darkness of the night to find a frightened lost lamb and bring him home again. Then He calls the children by name, blessing each one in a different way. These are special words that they will never forget. Words that they will treasure in their hearts for a lifetime.

**He sees
everything you
do to care for
these precious
little ones.**

He sees the tired faces of their mothers. He remembers His own mother and He speaks gentle words of encouragement. “Never forget that your Father in heaven loves you. He sees everything you do to care for these precious little ones. And you are precious to Him too. You are doing the most important work on earth.” They smile with joy.

David gives Jesus the pomegranate. The juice splashes as Jesus shares the rosy flesh. But He doesn't mind the stains on His linen robe. The children's joy is far more precious to Him than His clothes.

Sarah gives Jesus her flowers. He smiles and weaves them into a garland for her head, a crown for a princess. Whatever we give to Jesus, He will turn into something even more beautiful.

Love and laughter overflows from Jesus' lap. The disciples watch with wonder as the Son of God plays with the children of earth. And together they learn how to welcome little children, as Jesus welcomes them with love.

JESUS WELCOMES MOTHERS AND CHILDREN

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MEMORY VERSE ACTIVITIES

- Write the verse around a picture of a child.
- Make up actions to the verse for everyone to do together.

PRAYER ACTIVITIES

BLESSING EACH OTHER

- Jesus took the children in His arms and blessed them.
- Choose a blessing prayer from the Bible and pray it over each other (Numbers 6:24-26, Ephesians 3:14-21, etc.)

PRAYING ACROSS GENERATIONS

- In your family group ask each generation to pray for someone of another generation – parents and grandparents can pray for children and children can pray for parents or grandparents.
- What are the special prayer needs of people at different stages in their lives?

FAMILY ACTIVITIES

BLESS ALL AGES

- As a family, choose to bless a child or a family with children, and an older person or couple.
- You could write a prayer for them, make them an encouraging card, give them a gift, or treat, invite them for a meal, or visit with them and take something to make them feel happy and blessed.

TEACHING EACH OTHER

- Teach special skills or games across the generations. Parents can teach children something they enjoyed doing as a child, and the children can teach their parents a game that they like to play.
- Or teach practical skills, hobbies, gardening, or baking.

SWAP ROLES

- Swap roles for an hour where the children pretend to be the parents and the parents pretend to be the children.
- Role play putting the children to bed, or trying to clean the house, or another activity of your choice together.
- What did you learn about the people you were pretending to be for a while? How has this helped you to be kinder and more understanding?

VIDEO INTERVIEW

- Find a willing senior person in your church.
- Record or video the person telling the story of how God has been present in their lives over the years.
- What have they learned about God that they would like younger people to know and understand?

MONDAY SNAPSHOT!

THE VERSE

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THE INTRODUCTION

When we treat people of all ages with the same love, compassion, and respect, then we are treating people of diverse ages as Jesus treated them.

THE DEVOTIONAL

The disciples watch with wonder as the Son of God plays with the children of earth. And together they learn how to welcome little children, as Jesus welcomes them with love.

THE PRAYER

Thank God for the variety of ages in your family and how this helps you learn from each other’s experiences.

THE CONVERSATION

Ask each family member what the best part of their current age is and what the most challenging part is. Write down everyone’s responses to review and remember.